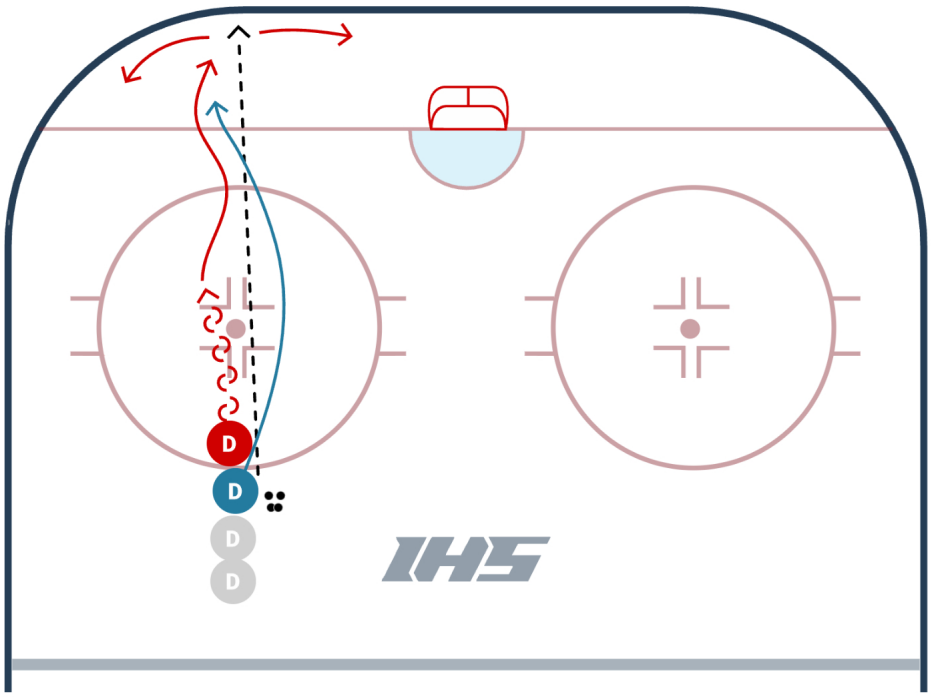
1 ON 1 RETRIEVALS



Time: **Station:**



The 1 on 1 Retrievals Drill from Phillip Barski focuses on puck retrievals under pressure, using deception, and transitioning into offensive plays from different breakout routes.

Setup

- Ideal for split ice situations with defensemen working separately from forwards.
- One puck-retrieving defenseman is positioned on one side of a faceoff circle, facing an oncoming forechecker.
- The forechecker begins with a puck and dumps it into the corner.

Execution

- The retrieving D takes a few backward strides, pivots at the dot, and heads toward the puck.
- The forechecker pressures the defenseman, simulating a real-game retrieval situation.
- The defenseman works on deception—using head, feet, or stick fakes—to evade the forechecker.
- If exiting on the strong side, the D climbs the wall, reaches the blue line, and takes a shot.
- If hooking the net, the D exits the opposite way, pivots, and shoots on goal from the other side.

Coaching Points

- This drill helps defensemen improve their puck retrieval skills under pressure.
- Puck retrieving D should practicing deception.
- Forcheckers should work on angling with stick on the ice.

Variations

- Can start the forechecker with light pressure and progress to have full pressure where the forechecker is awarded a point for a takeaway and the D is awared a point for a successful escape.

Supplemental Materials

- The second video shown is from Phillip's presentation on A Defenceman's Blueprint To Breaking Pucks Out at the Brock University High Performance Hockey Seminar.